

Perhaps the easiest solution outside of house hacking is to buy or rent an appropriately sized residence. Heat-maps have shown a majority of modern homes have rooms that are never used. This costs extra in taxes, utilities, and maintenance that can be eliminated by downsizing.

Stop Driving Yourself to the Poor House

Transportation is another area where you can make drastic improvements in your spending. Extreme voices may say to get rid of the car and walk or bike everywhere. Doing so would accelerate your journey to FI, in addition to the obvious health benefits, but realistically, American society is designed for cars, and they are an accepted part of everyday living. Most people, myself included, are not about to give up their car to achieve FI.

In Episode 22 of the *ChooseFI* podcast, Brad and Jonathan attempted to break down the true cost of car ownership. Jonathan's game plan is to approach car ownership from the standpoint of "even if I don't win, at least I don't lose as badly." This is a common-sense approach to car ownership. Make no mistake, there is plenty we can do to lose less badly.